

Purpose: To help us recognize the Lord’s hand in the Book of Mormon and to encourage us to study the Book of Mormon, follow its teachings, and share it with others.

1. Joseph Smith’s preparation to receive and translate the Book of Mormon.

Joseph Smith—History 1:29

JS—History 1:33-35, 42, 44-46, 53-54 Visit of the angel Moroni. ⇨ Lucy Mack Smith quote

Q: HOW DID THE LORD PREPARE JOSEPH TO RECEIVE AND TRANSLATE THE PLATES?

Q: HOW HAS THE LORD PREPARED YOU TO FULFILL YOUR RESPONSIBILITIES?

JS—History 1:50

Q: HOW DID JOSEPH’S FATHER RESPOND WHEN JOSEPH TOLD HIM OF MORONI’S VISIT?

Q: WHY IS IT IMPORTANT TO SUPPORT OUR FAMILY MEMBERS IN THEIR EFFORTS TO FOLLOW THE LORD?

Q: HOW CAN WE DO THIS?

2. The Miracle of the Book of Mormon’s preservation and translation.

JS—History 1:60-61

D&C 3:1-8 The works of God cannot be frustrated.

Q: HOW MIGHT OUR ACTIONS SOMETIMES SHOW THAT WE FEAR MAN MORE THAN GOD?

Q: WHAT ARE SOME THINGS WE CAN DO TO OVERCOME OUR FEAR OF MAN?

Q: WHAT EXPERIENCES HAVE SHOWN YOU THAT IF YOU ARE FAITHFUL, GOD WILL BE “WITH YOU IN EVERY TIME OF TROUBLE”?

D&C 3:12-15 For thou hast suffered the counsel of thy Director to be trampled upon

D&C 10:8-14 The cunning plan.

D&C 10:30, 38-45 Do not retranslate the same Large Plates of Nephi, but translate the Small Plates of Nephi instead.

1 Ne. 9:2-6 Nephi: “for a wise purpose”

W of Mormon 2-7 Mormon: “for a wise purpose”

⇨ Elder Neal A. Maxwell ⇨ Priscilla Sampson-Davis

3. Witnesses of the Book of Mormon.

D&C 5:11-19 Promise of three witnesses.

D&C 17:1-5 Promise to the witnesses.

Testimony of the Three Witnesses

David Whitmer wrote: “It is recorded in the American Encyclopaedia and the Encyclopaedia Britannica, that I, David Whitmer, have denied my testimony as one of the three witnesses to the divinity of the Book of Mormon, and that the other two witnesses, Oliver Cowdery and Martin Harris, denied their testimony to that book. I will say once more to all mankind, that I have never at any time denied that testimony or any part thereof. I also testify to the world, that neither Oliver Cowdery nor Martin Harris ever at any time denied their testimony. They both died reaffirming the truth of the divine authenticity of the Book of Mormon.” (Address to All Believers in Christ [1887], 8; as quoted in B. H. Roberts, A Comprehensive History of the Church, 1:145.)

Q: IN WHAT WAYS CAN WE BE WITNESSES OF THE BOOK OF MORMON?

YOUR TESTIMONY:

Elder Gordon B. Hinckley said: “The strength of the Church is not in ... its thousands of houses of worship across the world, nor in its universities.... The strength of this church lies in the hearts of its people, in the individual testimony and conviction of the truth of this work.” (Ensign, July 1973, 49)

4. Our Duty to “remember the new covenant, even the Book of Mormon.”

D&C 20:5-15 Warning.

D&C 84:54-62 Warning.

President Ezra Taft Benson said: “If the early Saints were rebuked for treating the Book of Mormon lightly, are we under any less condemnation if we do the same?” (Ensign, Nov. 1986, 4-5)

⇨ President Ezra Taft Benson quotes